

DR. ERIC JAMES MCDERMOTT

Product & Technology Leader



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AI product and technology leader with a PhD in neuroscience, combining product strategy and cross-functional leadership with hands-on development across LLM/ML systems, full-stack applications, APIs, data infrastructure, and cloud deployment. Principal Specialist AI at diconium, Founder & Head of Product of Meuccitech, and creator of BabyBaby, operating from C-level strategy and product discovery through architecture, implementation, adoption, and commercialization.

EXPERIENCE

DICONIUM DATA - STUTTGART

02/2022 - present

Principal Specialist AI

07/2024 - present

Previously Senior Specialist AI Innovation 04/2023–07/2024

- **Create and lead a 7-person cross-functional AI R&D team**, spanning data science, business analysis, UX, and product strategy to build and validate 0→1 AI products.
- **Hands-on full-stack AI development**: design and build LLM/ML pipelines, backend services, APIs, databases, frontend applications, and cloud deployments.
- **Lead products end-to-end**, from opportunity discovery and solution architecture through implementation, evaluation, guardrails, production rollout, and adoption.
- **Generative AI & knowledge systems**: built an agentic multimodal platform turning documents, images, and slide decks into a searchable, explainable knowledge layer; deployed a RAG-based enterprise assistant reducing time-to-find from days to minutes, raising documentation satisfaction from 60% to 85%, and scaling to 5+ use cases, including medical and pharma environments.
- **AI analytics & workflow automation**: built natural-language interfaces for structured data that reduced time-to-insight by 80% with 95% user satisfaction; automated content and labeling workflows, including NLP-driven SEO optimization that increased organic traffic by 45% and annotation pipelines that cut labeling time by 70% while improving consistency by 35%.
- **Applied ML & data products**: developed forecasting systems combining LSTM, Prophet, and XGBoost that outperformed ARIMA by 22% MAPE; used NLP embeddings and clustering to map 2,000+ employee skill trees; and developed synthetic-data pipelines using GANs and diffusion models for data-scarce environments.
- **AI strategy & organizational enablement**: partner with senior stakeholders to turn ambiguous opportunities into deployable solutions while scaling capability through technical coaching, reusable architectures, and company-wide enablement.

04/2023 - 07/2024

Senior Product Manager | Data

02/2022 - 04/2023

- **€10M+ data-platform opportunity**: led development of a PoC enabling scalable sourcing, storage, and querying of labeled data for ML and business analytics.
- **Volkswagen Group AI strategy**: authored an AI roadmap and developed an enterprise AI maturity model to support KPI definition, investment planning, portfolio prioritization, and identification of R&D, hiring, and M&A opportunities.
- **Data as a Product**: drove cross-organizational adoption, facilitating company-wide alignment across engineering and product teams and shipping the company's first internal AI data product: a synthetic-data pipeline.
- **AI portfolio optimization**: identified overlapping initiatives and harmonized work across product groups, improving portfolio focus and resource allocation.

MEUCCITECH - TÜBINGEN & TALLINN

01/2023 - present

Founder and Head of Product

- **0→1 AI product**: founded and built an AI audiobook production platform from concept to a production system delivering commercial audiobooks for publishing partners.
- **Hands-on product & engineering**: personally built across generative-AI workflows, backend services, frontend functionality, APIs and integrations, data infrastructure, and cloud deployment.
- **Production AI architecture**: designed end-to-end pipelines combining voice AI, automated processing, human-in-the-loop review, and QA to produce production-ready audio at scale.
- **Enterprise sales & partnerships**: secured commercial agreements with SAGA and a high-volume self-publishing platform serving ~1,000 publishers/authors per month; led executive discussions and pilots with major publishing groups including Bonnier, Carlson, and Mondadori, while building partnerships with voice agencies and professional voice actors.
- **Scale & operations**: built production capability that has delivered 1,000+ hours of commercial AI-generated audio, with an average 4.8-day upload-to-final-audio turnaround across completed projects and 92% delivered within two weeks.

EXPERIENCE CONT.

BABYBABY APP - TÜBINGEN

02/2026 - present

Creator

- **AI-native product development:** designed, built, and launched an AI-enabled companion for new parents spanning care tracking, personalized insights, evidence-grounded AI Q&A, and memory book creation. Own product, UX, architecture, frontend/backend, data, AI integration, deployment, and iteration, using AI coding agents (Codex, Claude Code) extensively throughout development.

MEDICAL INNOVATIONS INCUBATOR - STUTTGART & TÜBINGEN

09/2018 - 02/2022

Technical and Business Liaison

- **Healthtech product & commercialization:** supported 20+ early-stage ventures from concept toward regulatory approval and commercialization, product strategy, data readiness, MDR compliance, & prototyping; multiple teams secured funding or clinical pilots.
- **Ecosystem leadership:** connected founders with engineers, hospitals, investors, accelerators, and clinical partners to align product, regulatory, funding, and commercialization requirements.

REHALITY - TÜBINGEN

07/2017 - 02/2022

Project Lead / Co-Founder

- **XR/ML healthtech R&D:** co-founded a post-stroke rehabilitation initiative integrating XR, ML, EEG/EMG, eye tracking, and real-time biosensor feedback; designed clinical studies and developed adaptive rehabilitation prototypes.
- **Leadership & funding:** helped secure BMBF grant funding and led a multidisciplinary consortium spanning four academic, clinical, engineering, and industry partners.

PROMETHEUS SCIENCE - TÜBINGEN

06/2017 - 10/2018

Project Lead / Acting CEO

- **Open-source scientific hardware:** built and commercialized a 3D-printed biology lab for microscopy, fluorescence imaging, optogenetics, and behavioral tracking at >90% lower cost than commercial systems; ran workshops across four continents and won a MedTech incubator competition.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

CENTRE FOR INTEGRATIVE NEUROSCIENCE - Neuroscience Researcher

Tübingen 2015-2017

INSTITUTE OF READING DEVELOPMENT - Instructor

San Diego 2013-2014

NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF MENTAL HEALTH AND NEURO SCIENCES - Fulbright Scholar

India 2011-2012

VETERANS AFFAIRS MEDICAL CENTER - Psychological Assistant

San Diego 2011

EDUCATION

PhD: Neural and Behavioral Sciences

Max Planck Institute, University of Tübingen, Germany

2017-2022

MSC: Neural and Behavioral Sciences

Max Planck Institute, University of Tübingen, Germany

2014-2016

BA: Psychology

San Diego State University, California

2007-2011

SKILLS

AI Product, Strategy & Commercialization

- 0→1 product development | Discovery & validation | AI product strategy | Portfolio prioritization | Build-vs-buy | KPI/ROI design | Market & competitive analysis | Go-to-market | Commercialization

AI Systems & Applied AI

- Agentic AI | RAG & knowledge retrieval | LLM applications | AI assistants & copilots | MCP/tool integration | Workflow automation | Evaluation & guardrails | Human-in-the-loop | ML/NLP

Software, Architecture & Cloud

- Full-stack development | Backend & APIs | Frontend | Data pipelines & databases | Cloud architecture & deployment | Production AI systems | Prototyping | CI/CD
- Python | TypeScript/JavaScript | FastAPI | SQL / Supabase | Azure / GCP | AWS | Hetzner | Codex | Claude Code | MS Copilot 365 | GitHub

Leadership & Transformation

- Cross-functional leadership | C-level communication | AI adoption | Change management | Coaching | AI governance | Responsible AI | GDPR | MDR/CE/FDA awareness | Quality assurance

ACADEMIC & PROFESSIONAL HIGHLIGHTS

Research: 6+ peer-reviewed publications in brain-computer interfaces, healthtech, and computational neuroscience · Supervised 6 graduate theses in AI, VR & Data Science

Teaching: Lecturer in Neuroscience & VR, University of Tübingen (MSc) · Lecturer in Psychology/Statistics, San Diego State University (BS)

Awards: Fulbright Scholar · Max Planck Society Award · ICDVRAT Early Career Investigator Award · Multiple hackathon 1st/2nd-place finishes

Certifications: AI Solution Product Manager · Lean Six Sigma · SAFe Agilist · Scrum Master · User Interface Design · Claude Architectural Foundations